

to value creation is the real advantage AI has introduced into this landscape.

Q. What does cloud technology mean for the SME segment?

A. SMEs often have the capability for customisation and offer unique solutions to their clients. This area is evolving quickly, so decisions made today may need adjustments in a year or two. What's essential is having a platform that evolves with you, providing next-generation updates as they become available. To support the requirements of SMEs, we provide a variety of APIs across levels and diverse models, from lightweight, cost-effective options to more advanced custom models. SMEs can select options based on their specific needs, and that flexibility—being able to deploy where and how they want—is at the heart of what Vertex AI and Google Cloud offer.

Q. What is the role of cloud technology in democratising and scaling AI through open source solutions?

A. I love the term 'democratising AI'—it captures one of the broad, emerging themes we're seeing as the direction of the industry. AI is transforming every industry, which means it must be accessible to everyone, from large enterprises to small companies and individual users. Our cloud platform makes this possible by bringing Google's leading technology onto a flexible, accessible platform. With both low-code and high-code, and even no-code options, users don't need to be developers or deep tech experts to utilise AI. Open source is a top priority for us, especially given the developer community here at this conference (Open Source India). We believe a lot of innovation will come from the talent we're seeing here, and providing them with a robust AI platform is certainly one of our key objectives.

Q. How does Google Cloud ensure secure and responsible use of open source and AI together?

A. Responsible AI is at the core of what we do at Google. Two aspects I will touch on are open models and community collaboration. Google Cloud's open source Gemma models come in various versions. These models have open weights, allowing users to download, modify, and finetune them, offering extensive flexibility. They are also available as multimodal models, enabling combined processing across text and images.

For Gemma models, we provide toolsets that support responsible AI features. For instance, Shield Gemma automatically categorises content, identifying hate speech or inappropriate material, and provides tools for efficient implementation. This is particularly helpful for companies handling content—be it images or text—who may not have dedicated teams to monitor and update these techniques. Tools like Shield Gemma, supported by Google and the open source community, allow users to integrate state-of-the-art content moderation within their framework, ensuring it remains current with the latest advancements. This highlights the flexibility of these tools, which can be implemented within any framework in use.

Q. How can the community ensure responsibility?

A. About two years ago, the understanding of responsibility in AI was quite fragmented. Today, even with varied interpretations, there is broader consensus on core principles like fairness and defining inappropriate content. This alignment on principles has become a solid foundation. Governments are setting standards, with the EU and the US leading in these efforts. India is also exploring relevant policies. This regulatory involvement helps define what

responsibility in AI truly means, which is an essential first step.

The challenge now lies in enforcement of responsible AI at scale. We need platforms and tools for automated detection and enforcement. Within the open source community, enthusiasm around model creation has surged over the last year, and I'm optimistic about seeing more responsible AI tools emerge. These tools will play a key role in evaluating how models are used and deployed. Responsible AI tools will mark the progress in enforcing responsibility within open source AI development.

Q. What kind of strategies do you think companies should adopt when they're trying to secure their cloud deployments?

A. I believe companies should adopt a platform mindset. With a platform approach, you gain a comprehensive set of tools and built-in security options, which are incredibly important. You can choose to engineer every component yourself, but it requires hiring security experts and investing in highly specialised tools to ensure your system's security. For most smaller businesses, where technology may not be their primary focus, it's advisable to rely on the security options provided by the platform and choose the right platform from the start.

Q. Could you elaborate on the impact of AI on talent and skill development in the cloud landscape?

A. I believe we don't have a shortage of jobs but a shortage of skills. Upskilling is essential, and it should go beyond individual efforts. While it's encouraging to see developers engaging in Qwicklabs and AI courses, talent development should focus on every part of the organisation, asking how each role can use new platforms and technologies. Organisations that embrace this technology will achieve much more than those that avoid it.